

ACCESSIBLE HOME ENTRY CHECKLIST & PLANNING GUIDE

Use this comprehensive 5-step checklist to evaluate your home entrance, plan safe ramp & deck dimensions, select durable slip-resistant materials, and prepare for your free in-home consultation.

SECTION 1: Current Entrance Assessment		SECTION 3: Construction Materials & Durability	
[]	Step Height & Total Rise: Measure vertical height from ground/driveway to top of doorway threshold.	[]	Pressure-Treated Wood: Classic natural wood option; requires periodic staining/sealing for weather protection.
[]	Doorway Opening Width: Verify clear opening width is at least 32 inches (36 inches recommended for wheelchairs).	[]	Premium Composite Decking: Low-maintenance slip-resistant composite; resists warping, splinters, and rot.
[]	Threshold Elevation: Check threshold lip height to ensure smooth transition (keep under 1/2 inch bevel).	[]	Structural Support Posts: 6x6 pressure-treated posts set in deep concrete footings for maximum stability.
[]	Approach Obstacles: Identify existing trees, hose bibs, gas meters, or garden beds in planned ramp path.	[]	Stainless Hardware: Marine-grade exterior fasteners and joist hangers to prevent corrosion.
SECTION 2: Ramp & Deck Layout Requirements		PRO MEASUREMENT TIP: If your porch is 24 inches above the ground, an ADA-compliant ramp requires 24 feet of ramp length plus 5'x5' turn landings. DM Home Improvement customizes layouts to fit compact yards safely!	
[]	ADA Slope Ratio (1:12): Standard safety slope requires 1 foot (12") of ramp length for every 1 inch of vertical rise.		
[]	Resting Landings: Level 5' x 5' (60" x 60") landings required at top entrance, bottom exit, and turns (>30' run).		
[]	Ramp Walking Width: Minimum 36 inches clear width between handrails for comfortable mobility access.		
[]	Turn Configuration: Determine layout type: Straight run, L-shape turn, 90-degree switchback, or u-turn.		

ACCESSIBLE HOME ENTRY CHECKLIST & PLANNING GUIDE (CONT.)

Essential safety features, long-term usability planning, and how to schedule your free on-site measurement & layout design.

SECTION 4: Essential Safety Features & Lighting

[]	Continuous Safety Handrails: Smooth, easy-grip handrails on both sides installed at 34 to 38 inches height.
[]	Slip-Resistant Surface: Textured composite planks, grooved wood finish, or non-skid ramp coating.
[]	Raised Edge Protection: 2-inch minimum safety curb or bottom rail to prevent wheels/walkers from slipping.
[]	Pathway Lighting: Integrated step riser LED lights, solar post caps, or motion-activated lamps.
[]	Flush Ground Transition: Smooth bevel transition plate at ramp base to eliminate tripping thresholds.

SECTION 5: Long-Term Usability & Home Value

[]	Multi-Mobility Usability: Designed for manual wheelchairs, power scooters, walkers, and strollers.
[]	Weather Protection Shield: Consider optional covered porch landing or pergola to shield entry from rain & snow.
[]	Curb Appeal & Value: Architectural styling painted/stained to match home exterior and boost property value.
[]	NC Building Code Permits: Built to meet North Carolina residential building codes & local inspection standards.

READY FOR A FREE IN-HOME ESTIMATE & MEASUREMENT?

Our experienced licensed NC team will visit your home, evaluate your entry space, provide custom layout recommendations, and give you an exact no-obligation estimate.

CALL DEREK DIRECTLY:
(910) 557-0915

Charlotte Office: 3440 Toringdon Way Suite 205
Website: www.dmhomeimprovementllc.com